

STI Basics Chart

DISEASE	TRANSMISSION	TYPES OF SEXUAL CONTACT THAT MAY PRESENT A RISK OF CONTRACTING THE DISEASE	COMMON SYMPTOMS	POSSIBLE COMPLICATIONS	TREATMENT
CHLAMYDIA (Bacteria)	Semen, pre-ejaculate (pre-cum), vaginal fluid.	Oral sex (mouth-penis, mouth-vagina) Vaginal sex (vagina-penis) Anal sex (anus-penis)	Often no noticeable symptoms. Potential for itching, discharge or burning during urination or ejaculation, pain in the lower abdomen or back, pain during intercourse, discharge from the vagina, bleeding between menstrual periods, nausea, or fever.	If left untreated, may lead to infection of the testicles or pelvic inflammatory disease (PID) in women, a serious medical condition that can lead to infertility. May cause infertility even without symptoms. Can be transmitted from mother to newborn during childbirth.	Curable with antibiotics.
GENITAL HERPES (Virus)	Skin-to-skin contact (usually genital), saliva may transmit virus from the mouth or lips. Transmission is possible even without an outbreak of sores.	Oral sex (mouth-penis, mouth-vagina, mouth-anus) Vaginal sex (vagina-penis) Anal sex (anus-penis)	Often no noticeable symptoms. May cause one or more sores, blisters, pimples, bumps, or a rash around mouth, genitals or anus, itching, burning, or tingling in either the genital area or the mouth, a fever, swollen glands or stiff neck and headache. May have repeated outbreaks that are generally less severe than the original.	May result in chronic painful condition particularly for people who have a weakened immune system. Can be transmitted from mother to newborn during childbirth.	No cure but medications can reduce the frequency and duration of outbreaks.
GENITAL WARTS (HPV) (Human papillomavirus)	Skin-to-skin contact (usually genital). Transmission is possible even without visible warts.	Oral sex (mouth-penis, mouth-vagina, mouth-anus) Vaginal sex (vagina-penis) Anal sex (anus-penis)	Often no noticeable symptoms but may cause raised or flat growths around genitals or anus that are usually flesh colored or whitish in appearance.	Certain strains of HPV are considered risk factors for cervical cancer. In very rare cases, it can be transmitted from mother to newborn during childbirth.	No cure but warts can be removed using creams, surgery, cryosurgery (freezing), or laser treatment. There is now a vaccine to prevent certain types of HPV infection, including types that cause cervical cancer.
GONORRHEA (Bacteria)	Semen, pre-ejaculate (pre-cum), vaginal fluid.	Oral sex (mouth-penis, mouth-vagina) Vaginal sex (vagina-penis) Anal sex (anus-penis)	May have discharge or burning during urination or ejaculation, pain in the lower abdomen or back, pain during intercourse, discharge from the vagina, bleeding between menstrual periods, nausea, or fever. For women, there are often no noticeable symptoms.	If left untreated, may lead to infection of the testicles or pelvic inflammatory disease (PID) in women, a serious medical condition that can lead to infertility. Can be transmitted from mother to newborn during childbirth.	Curable with antibiotics.
HEPATITIS A (Virus)	Feces.	Oral sex (mouth-penis, mouth-vagina, mouth-anus)	Often no noticeable symptoms but may cause fever, tiredness, aches, loss of appetite, nausea, abdominal pain, dark urine, and jaundice (yellowing of the skin and eyeballs).	In rare cases, may lead to severe liver infection and death.	Nearly all infections resolve on their own. There are vaccines to prevent hepatitis A.

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HEPATITIS B (Virus)	Blood, semen, pre-ejaculate (pre-cum), vaginal fluid.	Oral sex (mouth-penis, mouth-vagina) Vaginal sex (vagina-penis) Anal sex (anus-penis)	Often no noticeable symptoms but may cause mild flu-like symptoms including fever, tiredness, aches, loss of appetite, nausea, abdominal pain, dark urine, and jaundice (yellowing of the skin and eyeballs).	Can lead to chronic infection, cirrhosis (scarring of liver tissue) and cancer of the liver. Can be transmitted from mother to newborn during childbirth.	Nearly all infections resolve on their own but medications may be used to treat chronic illness. Alcohol and certain medicines should be avoided to prevent further liver damage. There are vaccines to prevent hepatitis B.
HIV/AIDS (Human Immuno-deficiency Virus)	Blood, semen, pre-ejaculate (pre-cum), vaginal fluid, breast milk.	Oral sex (mouth-penis, mouth-vagina) Vaginal sex (vagina-penis) Anal sex (anus-penis)	Often no symptoms for years but may cause fever, chills and sweats, fatigue, appetite loss, weight loss, muscle and joint pain, long-lasting sore throat, swollen lymph nodes, diarrhea, yeast infections, and skin sores.	Over time, can lead to acquired immune deficiency syndrome (AIDS), which can leave a body vulnerable to other infections or cancers normally controlled by a healthy immune system. Can be transmitted from mother to newborn during childbirth.	No cure or vaccine for HIV or AIDS. There are medications that allow people to live with HIV or AIDS for longer periods of time.
SCABIES & PUBIC LICE OR CRABS (Parasite)	Skin-to-skin contact (usually prolonged sexual contact), although in rare cases, can spread by contact with clothes, towels, bedding, and other personal items that were recently in contact with an infected person	Oral sex (mouth-penis, mouth-vagina) Vaginal sex (vagina-penis) Anal sex (anus-penis)	Intense itching usually in genital area, visible crab eggs (small, oval-shaped, beads) attached to the base of hair, may have dark or bluish spots on skin in the infested area as a result of bites.	Scratching area may lead to secondary bacterial infections.	Medicated shampoos and creams will kill mites/lice on the body. In addition, need to thoroughly clean all clothing, towels and bedding to prevent reinfection.
SYPHILIS (Bacteria)	Skin-to-skin contact (between syphilis sore and penis, vagina, anus or mouth).	Oral sex (mouth-penis, mouth-vagina) Vaginal sex (vagina-penis) Anal sex (anus-penis)	Painless sore on or around penis, vagina, mouth or anus; rash over the entire body or on the hands and soles of the feet, fever, swollen lymph glands, patchy hair loss, headaches, weight loss, muscle aches, and tiredness.	If left untreated, may damage heart, eyes, central nervous system and other organs. Can be transmitted from mother to fetus prior to birth.	Curable with antibiotics.
TRICHOMONIASIS (Parasite)	Semen, pre-ejaculate (pre-cum), vaginal fluid.	Vaginal Sex (vagina-penis, vagina-vagina)	Women may experience frothy, yellow-green vaginal discharge, discomfort during intercourse and urination, irritation and itching in the genital area and in rare cases, lower abdominal pain. Most men do not experience symptoms but may have irritation inside the penis, mild discharge, or slight burning during urination or ejaculation.	If left untreated, on rare occasions, leads to pelvic inflammatory disease (PID) in women, a serious medical condition that can lead to infertility.	Curable with antibiotics.